be a chef and Sunu chipped in saying it was her husband's dream to send him to the reputed Institute of Hotel Management, Aurangabad (IHMA), but only if they could afford the Rs 20 lakh fee for the course. That was all that it took. Rynell was told to study and score well in his exams. He did and the Tatas sent him to the institute which his father had thought he would never be able to afford for his son. The boy not only completed his course at IHMA but got a scholarship to Le Cordon Bleu in Australia to do his higher studies in hotel management. When he wrote to Ratan to inform him that he had got admission to the course, Ratan promptly sent him Rs 10 lakh to cover the expenses not covered by the scholarship. Sunu tells me as her melancholic look morphs into one of pride, 'My son finished his course, and I went for the convocation and stayed with him for two months and today, he is working in Sydney.'

She continues, 'I was a simple housewife; today I work for the Taj Public Service Welfare Trust (TPSWT).' The trust was set up shortly after the terror attack. It was mandated not only to provide immediate relief to those affected by the terror strike, but also to set up an institutionalized mechanism to support and rehabilitate those recovering from such tragic events. 'They taught me everything. My elder son is working in Ireland Hospital in Ireland, my younger son is in Sydney, and all this happened because of Sir Ratan Tata. He is God.'

Today, the former housewife speaks confidently in English. She stays in a residence provided by the Tatas and receives her husband's stipend and free medical care for life. Just before ending the interview with me, she narrates excitedly, 'Do you know what Ratan Tata said after the meeting got over?' "You have dinner with me." I said, "No. My parents are at home." He said, "If you can, please do have dinner with me."' She continues, 'I felt I was in heaven. I was not on earth. I never dreamt that Sir Ratan Tata would speak to me like this.'

Agnes Martis's husband, Faustine Martis, was shot on the first floor of the Taj and died the next day, on his wedding anniversary. She was all 'dressed and waiting for him', having cooked for a party that was not to be. It left her and her two children distraught. She recalls, 'There were many questions that were uppermost in my mind: How will I live? What will be my and my children's future? And who is going to support me financially? I didn't know what to do.'